

Smartwatch Carrier and Connectivity Guide for 2026

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Cellular Carriers Supporting Companion and Wearable Data Plans

A broad range of cellular providers in the US support companion or wearable data plans (enabling a smartwatch to share your primary phone number and connect independently via eSIM). The carriers that support these wearable data plans include:

1. Major National Postpaid Carriers

- Verizon Wireless: Offers companion plans via NumberShare (typically around \$10 to \$15/month depending on your main unlimited phone tier).
- AT&T: Offers companion plans via NumberSync (typically around \$10.99/month).
- T-Mobile: Offers companion plans via DIGITS / Watch Plans (ranging from \$10 to \$15/month).
- UScellular: Supports wearable lines integrated with regional postpaid structures.

2. Regional Carriers & Cable MVNOs

- Xfinity Mobile: Offers a \$10/month smartwatch add-on line that leverages Verizon's network infrastructure.
- Spectrum Mobile: Offers a \$10/month smartwatch add-on line that leverages Verizon's network infrastructure.
- C Spire: Supports a \$10/month regional watch plan.
- Cellcom: Supports regional wearable device pairing.
- Consumer Cellular: Supports cellular watch lines (primarily focused on Apple Watch companion setups).

3. Prepaid & Value Carriers (MVNOs)

- Google Fi natively supports any Google or Samsung Galaxy watch at no extra cost
- Boost Mobile offers a \$10/month smartwatch data plan with device pairing options.
- Metro by T-Mobile offers prepaid smartwatch line additions (typically \$10/month, occasionally discounted on promotions).
- Visible (by Verizon) offers a \$5/month wearable add-on line specifically supporting compatible Apple Watch and select Android smartwatches.
- Cricket Wireless (AT&T MVNO) offers a \$10/month unlimited smartwatch plan with specific device support (primarily Apple Watch).
- Red Pocket Mobile provides limited support for the Apple Watch exclusively on its GSMA (AT&T) network.

Supported Smartwatches / Wearables

Apple Watch Series & Ultra Lineups (GPS + Cellular Models)

Apple Watch SE (all generations)

Apple Watch Standard Series (such as Series 4 through Series 11)

Apple Watch Ultra (such as Ultra, Ultra 2, and Ultra 3)

Google Pixel Watches (older LTE models)

Google Pixel Watches (1st Generation to 4th Gen)

Samsung Galaxy Watches (older LTE models):

Samsung Galaxy Watches - Series 4 through 9 (including Classic and FE variants)

Samsung Galaxy Watch Ultra

Offline Step Tracking Without a Mobile Network

Virtually all newer smartwatches can track your footsteps completely offline without needing a cellular mobile network or even a nearby phone. Smartwatches use an internal accelerometer to physically measure arm swings and movement locally. Data is stored directly on the watch storage and auto-syncs to your phone later via Bluetooth or Wi-Fi when reconnected. Older smartwatches without this capability can still track footsteps with an additional application.

Standalone Third-Party Apps & Web Network

While most built-in fitness tracking works natively without internet connectivity, smartwatches can also use specialized standalone apps that operate locally on your wrist without requiring a constant network connection:

- [Quick Steps Counter Watch](#): A minimalist Wear OS smartwatch app focused purely on step counting, designed for low power consumption, rapid response, and zero ad tracking.
- [StepMelon](#): A cross-platform step-tracking application for Android and Wear OS smartwatches featuring a unique multi-tier goal system, rest days, offline local tracking, and a clean interface.

Highly Reviewed Alternatives for Wear OS

- [Google Fit](#) / [Health Connect](#): The stock fitness companion built directly into Wear OS. It features clean progress rings, maintains a simple and uncluttered watch display, and integrates smoothly with Android without third-party ads.
- [Fitbit](#) (by Google): Standard on Pixel Watches and available across Wear OS. It provides comprehensive step tracking, sleep metrics, and active zone tracking with a streamlined layout that avoids cluttering your watch screen.